

Role Based Application Access Package

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Platform Explorers – Cybersecurity

Microsoft Security Platform: Microsoft Entra ID

Overview

This use case outlines the process for a company to create access packages for specific applications based on user teams using Microsoft Entra ID Governance. The goal is to streamline access management by creating access packages and enforcing access reviews every quarter

Detailed Use Case

Scenario:

A company wants to streamline the process of granting access to specific applications for different user teams. The company has various teams, each requiring access to different sets of applications, groups, and resources. The company aims to manage this process using Microsoft Entra ID Governance to create access packages that bundle the necessary resources for each team.

Requirements:

Create access packages which can be assigned to users or groups

Allow for designated admins to approve or reject access

Automate access reviews every 6 months

The core outcome: **you can implement this entire access-package model in Entra ID Governance using Entitlement Management**, with quarterly (or 6-month) access reviews, approval workflows, and team-based assignment.

Below is a **fully structured, step-by-step implementation plan** tailored to your scenario, with **practical configuration guidance, architecture, and operational workflow**.

Takeaway

You will create **team-specific access packages** that bundle apps, groups, and resources; configure **approval workflows** for designated admins; and enforce **automated access reviews every 6 months** using Entra ID Governance.

1. Architecture Overview

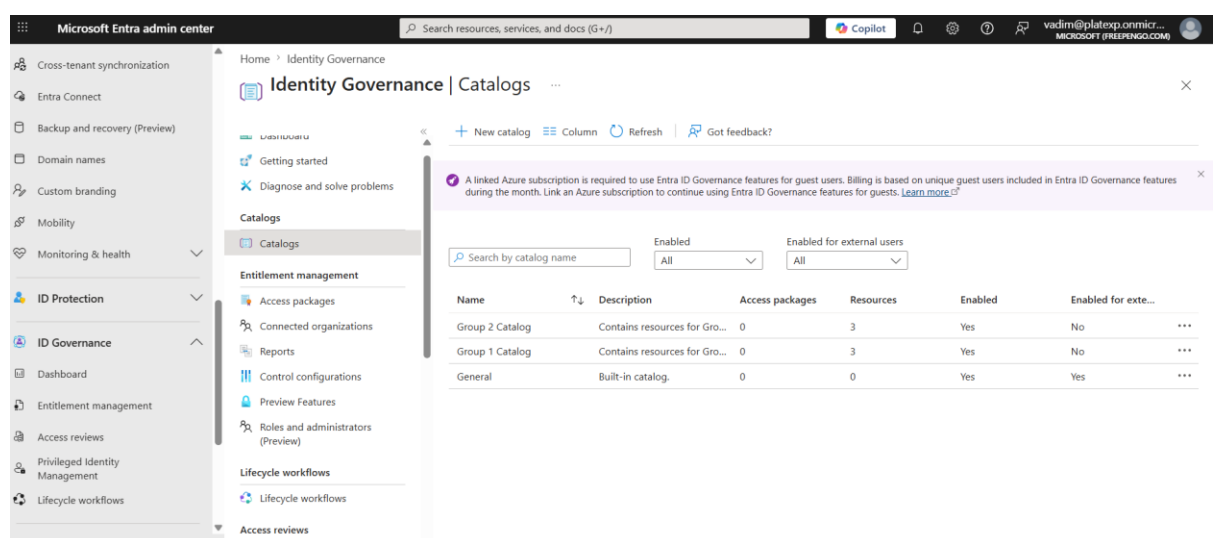
- Each team gets its own **Access Package**.
- Each package contains:
 - Entra security groups
 - Enterprise applications (SaaS or custom)
 - SharePoint sites (optional)
- Assignment is controlled by:
 - Direct user request
 - Group-based assignment
 - Manager approval
 - Designated approver approval
- Access is periodically validated using **Access Reviews**.

2. Step-by-Step Configuration

Step 1 — Create Catalogs

Catalogs help you logically group resources.

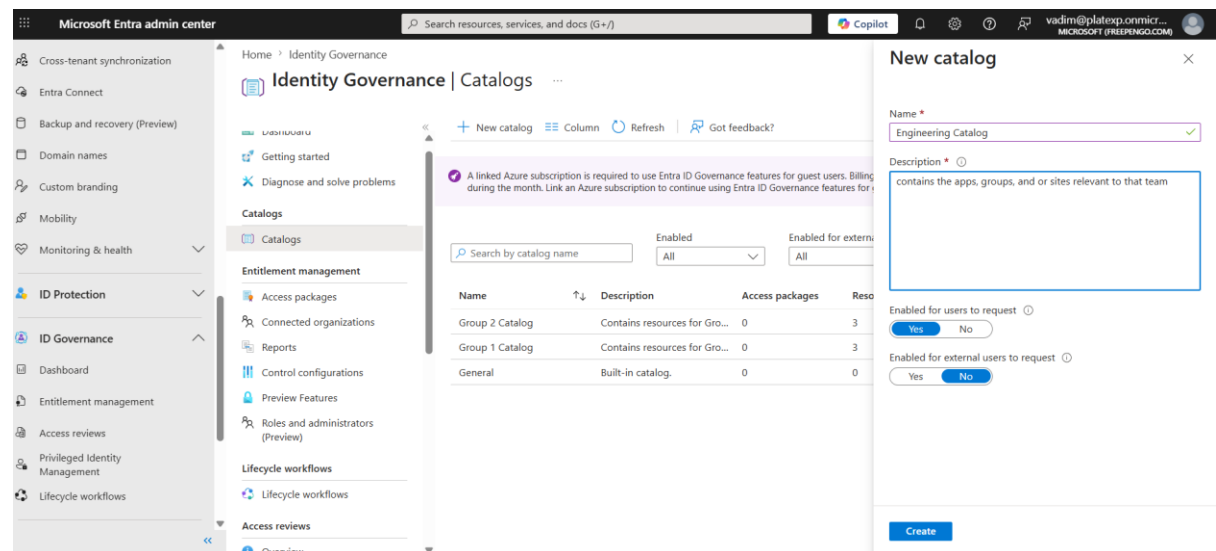
1. Go to **Entra ID** → **Identity Governance** → **Entitlement Management** → **Catalogs**



2. Create catalogs such as:
 - **Engineering Catalog**
 - **Finance Catalog**
 - **Sales Catalog**

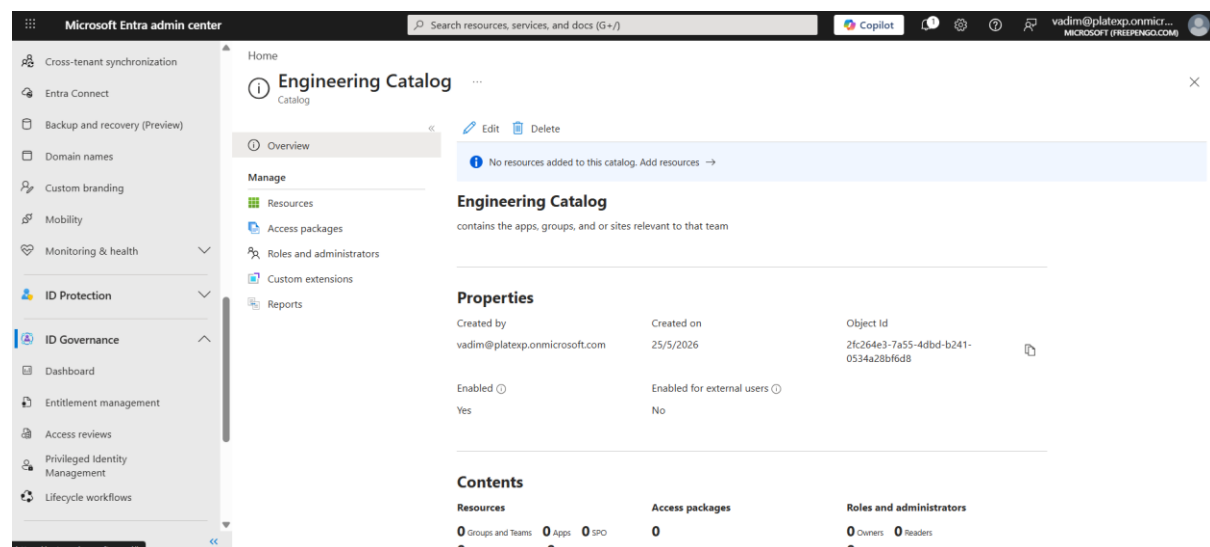
Each catalog will contain the apps, groups, and sites relevant to that team.

- create catalog

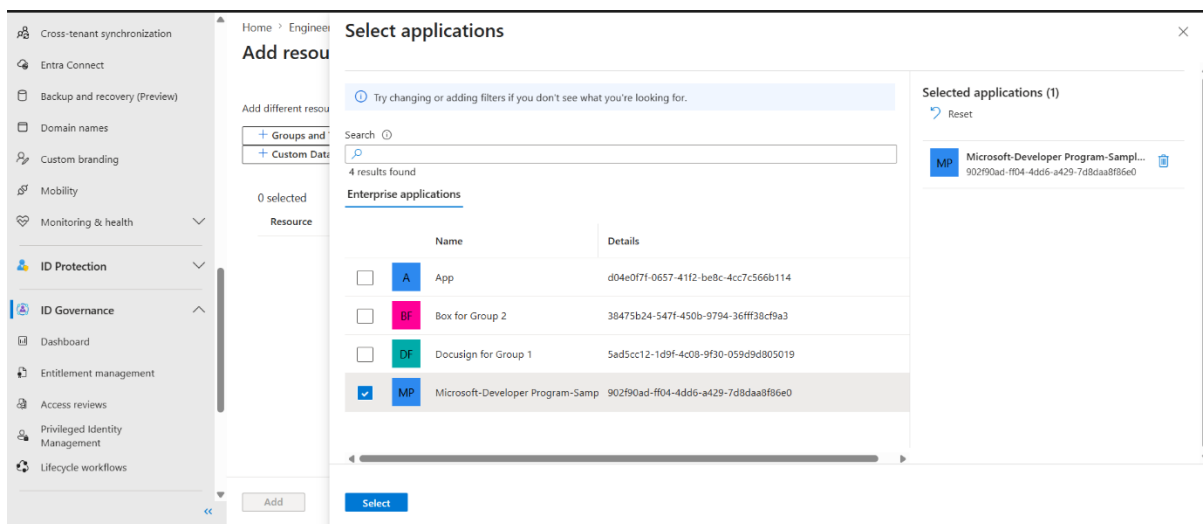
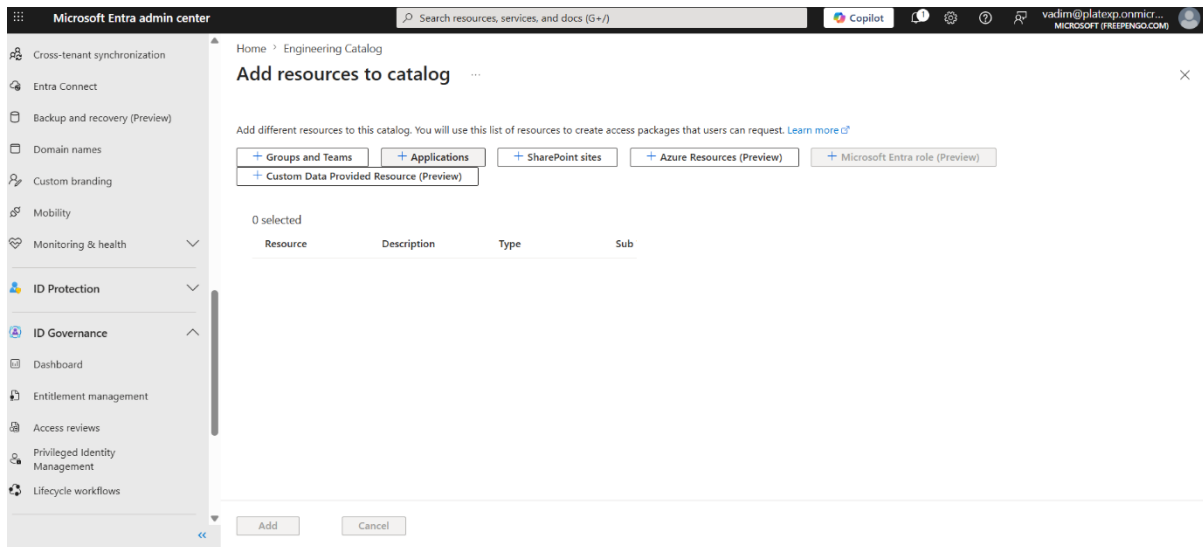


Step 2 — Add Resources to Each Catalog

For each catalog, add:



- **Applications (Enterprise Apps)**



- **Microsoft 365 Groups / Security Groups**
- **SharePoint Sites** (if needed)

Example for Engineering:

- App: Jira
- App: GitHub Enterprise
- Group: Engineering-All
- Site: Engineering Docs

Step 3 — Create Access Packages

For each team:

1. Go to **Entitlement Management** → **Access Packages** → **New Access Package**

Microsoft Entra admin center

Home > Engineering Catalog > Add resources to catalog > Identity Governance | Access packages > New access package > Identity Governance | Access packages

New access package

* Basics Resource roles * Requests Requestor information * Lifecycle Custom extensions Review + create

Access package

Create a collection of resources that users can request access to.

Name * Access-users-request ✓

Description * access package request to different sets of applications, groups, and resources

Catalog * Group 2 Catalog

[Learn more.](#) [Create new catalog](#)

[Review + create](#) [Next: Resource roles >](#)

2. Select the appropriate catalog

Microsoft Entra admin center

Home > Engineering Catalog > Add resources to catalog > Identity Governance | Access packages > New access package > Identity Governance | Access packages

Select applications

Try changing or adding filters if you don't see what you're looking for.

☐ See all Application(s) not in the 'General' catalog. You must have the correct permissions to add them in this access package.

Search by name

1 result found

All Users Groups Devices Enterprise applications App registrations Administrative units

	Name	Type	Details
☒	MP Microsoft-Developer Program-Samp	Enterprise ap...	902f90ad-f04-4dd6-a429-7d8daa8f86e0

Selected applications (1)

[Reset](#)

MP Microsoft-Developer Program-Samp
902f90ad-f04-4dd6-a429-7d8daa8f86e0

[Review + create](#) [Select](#)

3. Add resources (apps, groups, sites)

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New access package

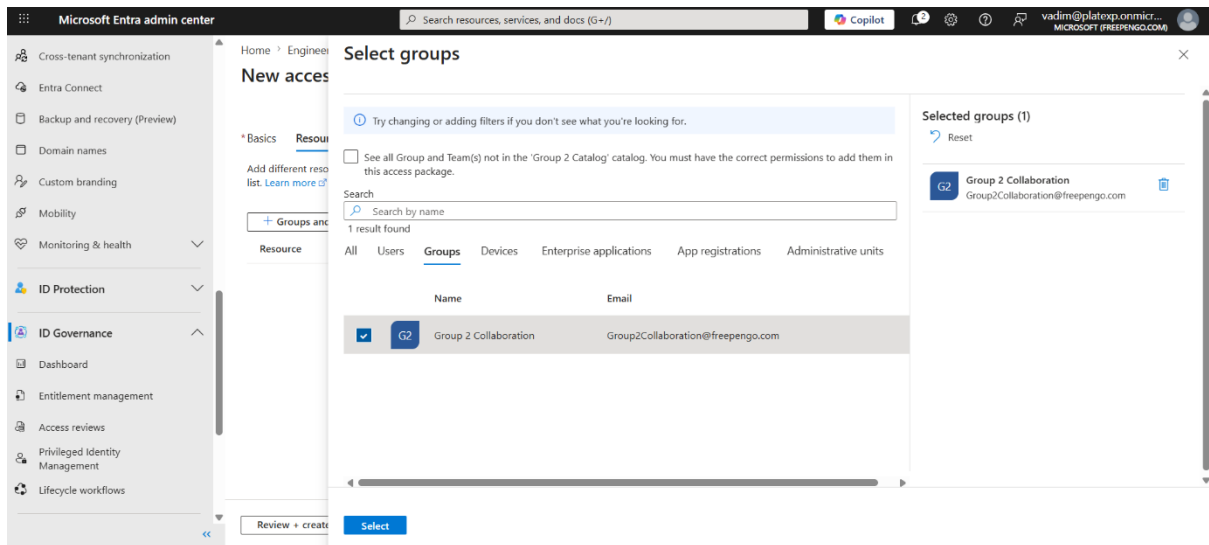
* Basics Resource roles * Requests Requestor information * Lifecycle Custom extensions Review + create

Add different resources to this access package. Specify the permissions associated with each resource by selecting a role from the drop-down list. [Learn more.](#)

[+ Groups and Teams](#) [+ Applications](#) [+ SharePoint sites](#) [+ Azure Resources \(Preview\)](#) [+ Microsoft Entra role \(Preview\)](#) [+ API Permissions](#)

Resource	Type	Sub Type	Role *
Microsoft-Developer Program-Sample Data ...	Application	Application	Default Access

[Review + create](#) [Previous](#) [Next: Requests >](#)



4. Configure assignment policies

Example packages:

- **Engineering Access Package**
- **Finance Access Package**
- **Sales Access Package**

Guided links:

- create access package

Step 4 — Configure Assignment Policies

This is where you define **who can request access** and **who approves it**.

Key settings:

A. Who can request access

Options:

- Specific users
- Entire directory
- External users
- Groups (recommended for team-based access)

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Cross-tenant synchronization

Entra Connect

Backup and recovery (Preview)

Domain names

Custom branding

Mobility

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ID Governance

Dashboard

Entitlement management

Access reviews

Privileged Identity Management

Lifecycle workflows

Home > Engineering Catalog > Add resources to catalog > Identity Governance | Access packages > New access package > Identity Governance | Access packages

New access package

Who can get access

Who can get access *

☒ For users, service principals, and agent identities in your directory
Allow users, groups, service principals, and agent identities in your directory to get access to this access package

☐ For users not in your directory
Allow users in connected organizations (other directories and domains) to get access to this access package

☐ None (administrator direct assignments only)
Allow administrators to directly assign specific users to this access package. No subjects can get access without being explicitly assigned by administrator.

Select specific scope

☒ Specific users and groups

☐ All members (excluding guests)

☐ All users (including guests)

☐ All service principals

☐ All agents

Please fix the errors on this page before continuing.

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New access package

+ Add users and groups

Please add at least 1 group where policy is applied.

Who can request access

Who can request access *

☐ Self

☒ Admin
Admin can't be turned off because admins will always be able to assign users to an access package.

☐ Manager

☒ Enabling on-behalf-of requests requires a Microsoft Entra ID Governance subscription. [Learn more.](#)

Approval

Require approval *

Yes

No

Require requestor justification

Yes

No

Please fix the errors on this page before continuing.

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Home > Engineering Catalog > Add resources to catalog > Identity Governance | Access packages > New access package > Identity Governance | Access packages

New access package

Select groups

Policy scope

Try changing or adding filters if you don't see what you're looking for.

Search

42 results found

All Users Groups

☐ A aremu
aremu@platexp.onmicrosoft.com

☒ G2 Group 2 Collaboration
Group2Collaboration@freepengo.com

☐ A azeez
azeez@platexp.onmicrosoft.com

☐ I Info
info@freepengo.com

☐ C chimdinma
chimdinma@platexp.onmicrosoft.com

Selected users and groups (1)

Reset

G2 Group 2 Collaboration
Group2Collaboration@freepengo.com

Please fix the errors on this page before continuing.

Review + create

Select

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New access package

Agent scope is part of Microsoft Agent 365, the control plane for agents. Get access to Agent 365 via the Frontier program. [Learn more.](#)

Select users and groups

Group 2 Collaboration

+ Add users and groups

Who can request access

Who can request access *

☒ Self

☒ Admin
Admin can't be turned off because admins will always be able to assign users to an access package.

☐ Manager

Enabling on-behalf-of requests requires a Microsoft Entra ID Governance subscription. [Learn more.](#)

Approval

Please fix the errors on this page before continuing.

Review + create Previous Next: Requestor Information >

B. Approval Workflow

Enable:

- **Approval required: Yes**
- **Approver type: Designated Approvers**
- Add team managers or application owners

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Home > Engineering Catalog > Add resources to catalog > Identity Governance | Access packages > New access package > Identity Governance | Access packages

New access package

Approval

Require approval *

Yes No

Require requestor justification

Yes No

How many stages

1 2 3

First Approver

Sponsors as approvers requires a Microsoft Entra ID Governance subscription. [Learn more.](#)

Choose specific approvers

Select approvers

clement

+ Add approvers

Decision must be made in how many days? *

2 Maximum 14

Require approver justification

Yes No

Review + create Previous Next: Requestor Information >

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New access package

How many stages 1 2 3

First Approver

Sponsors as approvers requires a Microsoft Entra ID Governance subscription. [Learn more](#)

Choose specific approvers

Select approvers clement

+ Add approvers

Decision must be made in how many days? 2 Maximum 14

Require approver justification Yes No

[Show advanced request settings](#)

Email Notifications

Disable assignment emails Yes No

Review + create Previous Next: Requestor information >

C. Lifecycle

Set:

- **Access expiration: 6 months**
- **Require re-approval: Yes**
- **Require justification: Optional**

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New access package

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Expiration

Access package assignments expire On date Number of days Number of hours Never

Assignments expire after (number of days) 14

Users can request specific timeline Yes No

[Hide advanced expiration settings](#)

Allow users to extend access Yes No

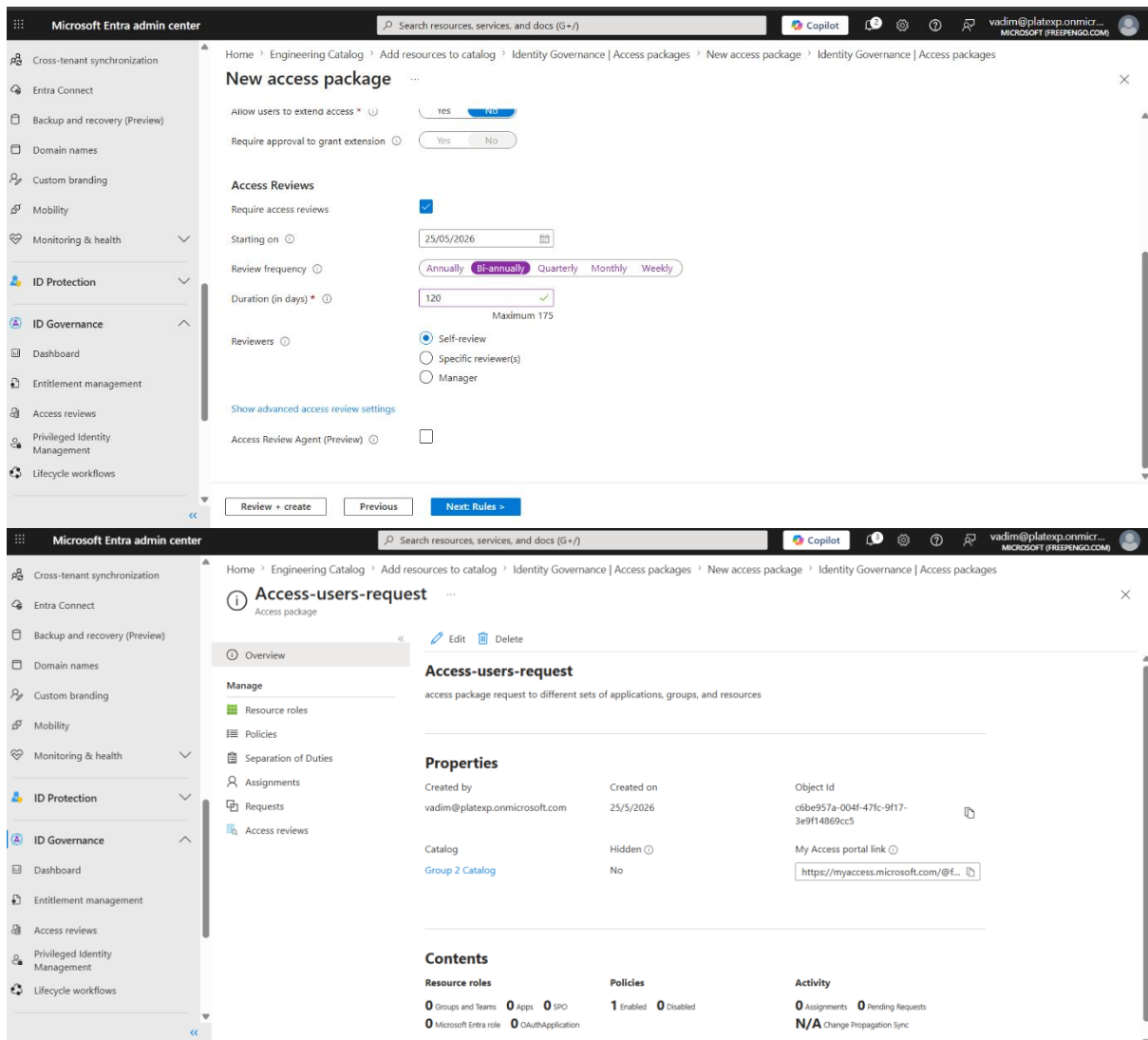
Require approval to grant extension Yes No

Access Reviews

Require access reviews

Starting on 25/05/2026

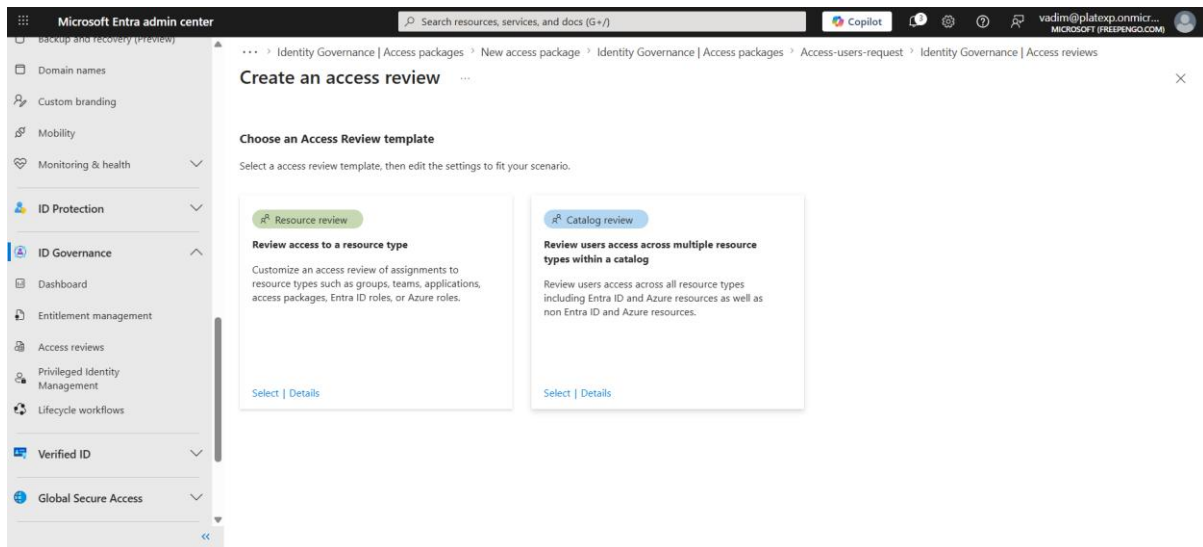
Review + create Previous Next: Rules >



Step 5 — Automate Access Reviews (Every 6 Months)

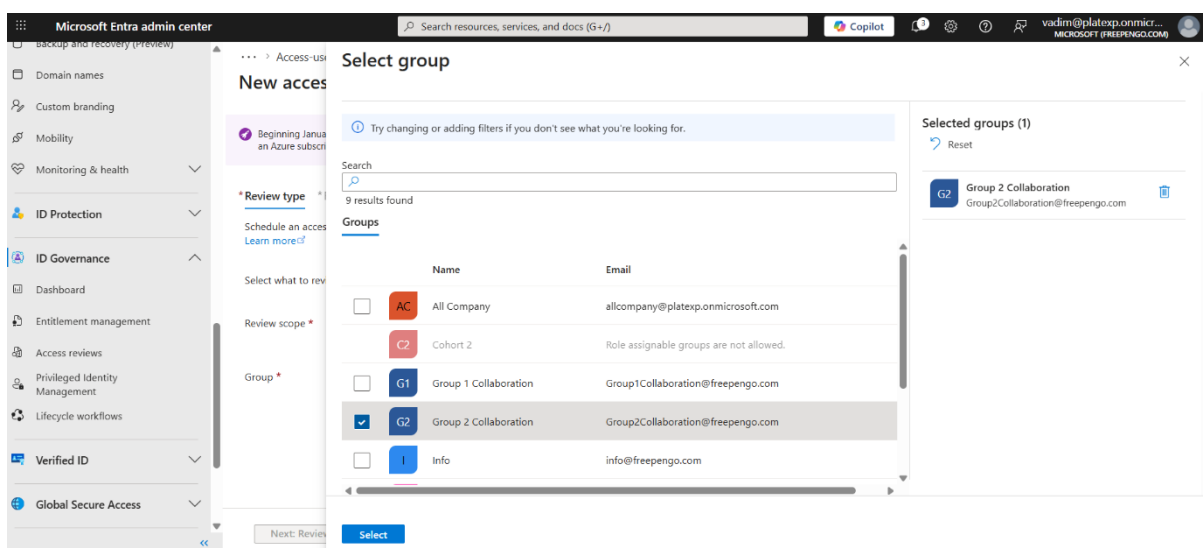
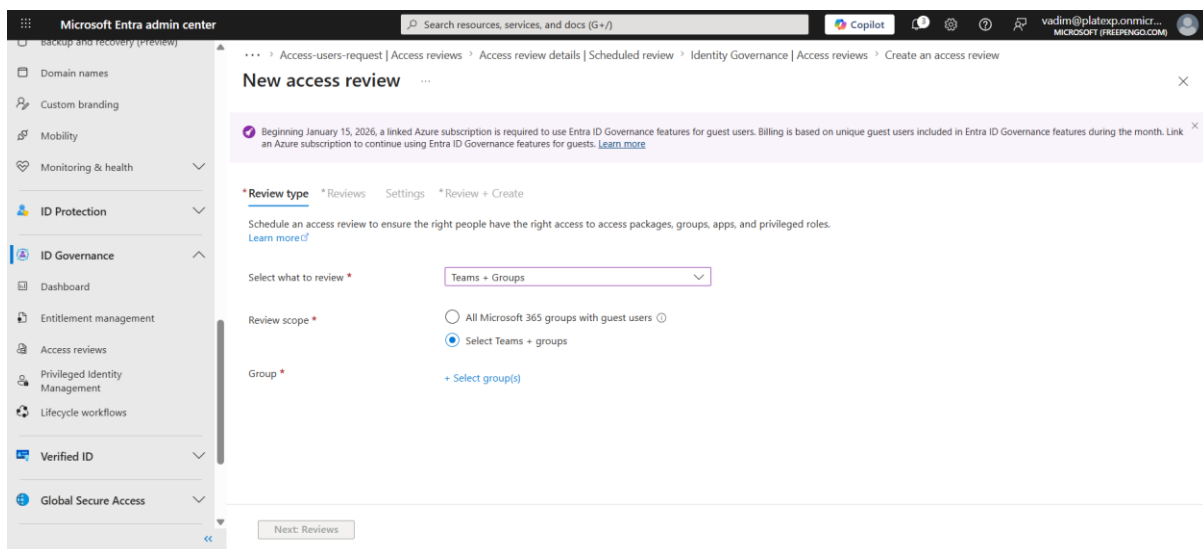
Access Reviews ensure users still need the access.

1. Go to **Identity Governance** → **Access Reviews**
2. Create a new review



Here we choose resource review

3. Select Teams Access Packages



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Access-users-request | Access reviews | Access review details | Scheduled review | Identity Governance | Access reviews | Create an access review

New access review

Beginning January 15, 2026, a linked Azure subscription is required to use Entra ID Governance features for guest users. Billing is based on unique guest users included in Entra ID Governance features during the month. Link an Azure subscription to continue using Entra ID Governance features for guests. [Learn more](#)

Review scope *

☐ All Microsoft 365 groups with guest users

☒ Select Teams + groups

Group *

Group 2 Collaboration

Scope *

☐ Guest users only

☒ All users

In public preview, 828 direct connect users and teams in shared channels are included in access reviews. 828 direct connect users and teams are not supported in reviews of 'All Microsoft 365 groups with guest users', as well as reviews scoped to inactive users. Click here to learn more.

Inactive users only ☐

Next: Reviews

4. Reviewers:

- Managers, or
- Resource owners, or
- Self-review

5. Recurrence:

- Every 6 months

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Select reviewers *

Selected user(s) or group(s)

Users or Groups *

clement

Specify recurrence of review

Duration (in days) *

3

Review recurrence *

Semi-annually

Start date *

25/05/2026

End *

☐ Never

☒ End on specific date

☐ End after number of occurrences

End date *

26/11/2026

Previous Next: Settings

6. Auto-apply results:

- Remove access if not approved

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Verified ID

Global Secure Access

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Review type | Reviews | Settings | Review + Create

Configure additional settings, including decision helpers and email notifications.

Upon completion settings

Auto apply results to resource ☐

If reviewers don't respond

At end of review, send notification to [+ Select User\(s\) or Group\(s\)](#)

Enable reviewer decision helpers

No sign-in within 30 days ☐

User-to-Group Affiliation ☐

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Enable reviewer decision helpers

No sign-in within 30 days ☐

User-to-Group Affiliation ☐

Advanced settings

Justification required ☒

Email notifications ☒

Reminders ☒

Additional content for reviewer email

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Access-users-request | Access reviews | Access review details | Scheduled review | Identity Governance | Access reviews | Create an access review

New access review

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Review type | Reviews | Settings | Review + Create

Name new access review

Review name *

Description

Confirm access review + create

Resources

Selected resource

1 group selected

Review scope

Everyone

< Previous | Create

3. Operational Workflow

User Flow

1. User requests access to a team package
2. Approver receives notification
3. Approver approves or rejects
4. User is automatically added to groups/apps
5. After 6 months, access review triggers
6. If not approved, access is removed automatically

Admin Flow

- Admin monitors requests
 - Admin reviews access review outcomes
 - Admin updates packages as apps change
-

4. Governance Best Practices

A. Use Group-Based Assignment

Assign users to a **Team-Engineering** or **Team-Finance** group, and let the group request the package automatically.

B. Use Expiration + Access Reviews Together

This ensures:

- No permanent access
- Regular validation
- Reduced privilege creep

C. Use Catalog Owners

Catalog owners can manage resources without global admin involvement.
